

Contributing to the BIAS-VI API

First off, thank you for considering contributing to the BIAS-VI API! The ETV Institute relies on a community of data scientists, engineers, and Community Violence Intervention (CVI) practitioners to keep this tool effective and culturally safe.

The "Translators" Philosophy

Before contributing code or prompt adjustments, please understand our core philosophy: **We do not judge language by corporate or academic standards. We judge it by street context.**

If you are suggesting a change to the core AI logic (System Prompts), you must provide evidence or lived-experience context as to why the change improves the model's ability to distinguish between expressive grief/frustration and actionable violence.

How to Contribute

1. Reporting False Positives

If you find that the API is flagging harmless street vernacular as a threat, please open an Issue.

- Include the exact text that was flagged.
- Include the cultural context/meaning of the phrase.
- Suggest how the `TRANSLATOR_SYSTEM_PROMPT` could be updated to catch this in the future.

2. Submitting Pull Requests

1. Fork the repository.
2. Create a new branch for your feature or bugfix (`git checkout -b feature/improve-extraction`).
3. Write tests for your changes in `test_api.py` .
4. Ensure all tests pass by running `python test_api.py` .
5. Submit a Pull Request with a detailed description of the changes.

3. The Anti-Surveillance Rule

CRITICAL: We will automatically reject any Pull Request that attempts to add features for tracking individuals, scraping Personally Identifiable Information (PII), or integrating with law enforcement databases. This API tracks *decisions and patterns*, never people.

Code of Conduct

By participating in this project, you agree to respect the dignity of the communities this tool serves. Harassment, racism, or dismissive attitudes toward lived experience will result in an immediate ban from the repository.